

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, mostly sunny, high 42. To-
night, partly cloudy, areas of late-
night fog, low 34. Tomorrow, areas of
morning fog, mostly sunny, warmer,
high 50. Weather map, Page A22.

VOL. CLXXV No. 60,808

© 2026 The New York Times Company

FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



ANDREW TESTA FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Rustic View of Stagnation and Inequality
West Yorkshire, where Emily Brontë wrote “Wuthering Heights,” offers a window into the forces disrupting British politics. Page A6.

As Trump Claims Minnesota Victory, Some Ask What Was Won

By ZOLAN KANNO-YOUNGS and ERNESTO LONDOÑO
WASHINGTON — When the Trump administration announced it was scaling down its surge of federal agents to Minneapolis earlier this month, the White House was quick to take a victory lap.
President Trump’s adviser on the border, Tom Homan, said the administration decided to pull back many of the roughly 3,000 agents after it had secured “an unprecedented level of coordination with law enforcement officials” on immigration enforcement. The

White House claimed that nearly every county in Minnesota had established new agreements to help transfer undocumented immigrants in their jails to federal custody.
“The Twin Cities of Minnesota in general are and will continue to be much safer for the communities here because of what we have accomplished under President Trump’s leadership,” said Mr. Homan, who wound down a two-month operation that led to thousands of arrests and the deaths of two U.S. citizens at the hands of immigration agents.

Show of Force Could Be Seen as Warning to Democratic States

But sheriffs and public officials across the state say little, if anything, has changed about their immigration enforcement policies. In fact, many of them said they were already cooperating and that the operation in Minneapolis had nothing to do with it.
The office of Gov. Tim Walz of

Minnesota, a Democrat, said it was unaware of a single policy change on immigration cooperation at the state, city or county level. The sheriff’s office in Hennepin County, which includes Minneapolis and is the only county in the state to explicitly ban coordinating with federal authorities on civil immigration enforcement, said its policies remained unchanged. Sheriff’s offices in three of the other six largest counties in Minnesota said they had not signed any new agreements with the administration. The two others did
Continued on Page A16

Bird Losses Accelerate in an Ominous Sign for the Environment

By CATRIN EINHORN
Birds in the United States are not only declining, but they are declining faster, especially in areas with intensive agriculture, according to new research. Overall drops in bird population, measured from 1987 to 2021, were sharpest in warm and warming areas, suggesting that climate change may play a role.
The study, published on Thursday in the journal Science, shows only correlation with intensive agriculture and temperature, not causation. It does not factor in other circumstances that may be affecting birds along migratory routes or while they are overwintering. But it adds to an ever more robust body of evidence that birds — one of the best-measured families of animals on Earth, and a sentinel for the health of other species — are not OK.
Whatever the specific drivers, the accelerating losses make sense given society’s focus on economic growth, which often comes at a cost to the natural world, said Peter P. Marra, an ornithologist and dean at Georgetown University who specializes in bird populations and was not involved with the new research.
“The American dream turns into the American nightmare as we start to look at what we’re doing to biodiversity and systems that we depend on as humans,” he said.
In 2019, Dr. Marra and a team of scientists published landmark findings that the number of birds in the United States and Canada



MICAH GREEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

The steepest drops from 1987 to 2021 were in Florida, Texas, Louisiana and Arizona, a study found.
had fallen by 2.9 billion, or 29 percent, since 1970.
Thursday’s study relied on one of the same data sources, the North American Breeding Bird Survey, a monitoring project led in part by the United States Geological Survey. Observers count birds along designated routes of roughly 25 miles each. To analyze rates of decline, the new research was limited to 1,033 routes that offered yearly or almost yearly counts, and ultimately included 261 bird species.
In 1987, the team found, each route had 2,034 birds on average. By 2017, that average had decreased by 304 birds per route, or 15 percent. The steepest losses were seen in Florida, Texas, Louisiana and Arizona. Generally, they

correlated with warm places and, to a lesser degree, with places that saw rising temperatures over the past 30 years.
The researchers also found that bird declines have sped up over time. On average, each route lost what amounted to an additional quarter of a bird per year compared with the previous year.
Continued on Page A21

Israel Restless As It Confronts A 2nd Iran War

Worry and Resignation Awaiting Call by U.S.

By AARON BOXERMAN
JERUSALEM — Across Israel, hospitals have been conducting emergency drills while neighbors share locations of bomb shelters in WhatsApp groups.
The national mood is wavering somewhere between anxiety, resignation and anticipation as President Trump deliberates over whether to attack Iran. If he orders a strike, it will most likely bring Israel into its second war with Iran in less than a year, following a 12-day conflict in June.
Ruth Bahaj of Jerusalem, 38, said she was trying to maintain a semblance of normalcy, including by heading on a vacation this week. But she and her wife also made preparations, such as cleaning and organizing the fortified shelter in their apartment building.
“Plenty of people are anxious, aren’t sleeping at night because they’re checking the news,” Ms. Bahaj said. “But it’s impossible to be tense and at the ready constantly for so long.”
Mr. Trump first began threatening to attack Iran last month after Iran’s leaders began a bloody crackdown on mass protests calling for an end to the country’s authoritarian clerical rule. He has ordered a buildup of American military power in the region unparalleled since the U.S.-led invasion of Iraq in 2003.
But he has also zigzagged between declaring his readiness to attack Iran and expressing a desire to use a moment of weakness in the country to reach a new diplomatic agreement to rein in Iran’s nuclear program.
U.S. officials have held rounds of talks with Iranian counterparts, so far without reaching any deal that could avert another round of conflict.
Jewish Israelis often do mandatory reserve duty in the military, leaving many clutching at rumors of who has been called up in an attempt to decipher whether a war could be imminent. Another barometer has been airline cancellations: KLM, the Dutch carrier, announced this week that it would suspend its service to Tel Aviv starting Mar. 1.
Many Israelis share Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s view that the Iranian government’s nuclear and missile programs pose
Continued on Page A11

FOR TRUMP, GOAL OF STRIKING IRAN MAY BE SYMBOLIC

CHANCE TO CLAIM A WIN

Officials Have Hopes and Doubts of Foe Ending Nuclear Work

By JULIAN E. BARNES and HELENE COOPER
WASHINGTON — The targeted strikes on Iran being considered by the Trump administration would probably be aimed at nuclear and missile sites in the country. But the president has yet to specify, to either the American people or the troops who would carry out his orders, exactly what he wants this military engagement to accomplish.
In his State of the Union speech on Tuesday, President Trump appeared to suggest a goal — that Iran needs to say the “secret words” that it will never have a nuclear weapon. But Iran has already essentially made that promise, even if it has enriched enough uranium to make intelligence officials scoff.
U.S. officials say that they doubt Iran is ready to make a deal, but that the strategy behind targeted strikes would be to force its leaders to make concessions.
More immediately, the objective would be to damage Iran’s nuclear and missile facilities.
Mr. Trump declared that Iran’s three most important nuclear sites were “obliterated” in U.S. strikes last year. They were not obliterated, but they are not operational, either, according to officials who have reviewed the intelligence.
For Israel, the most critical immediate threat is Iran’s missiles. Destroying them would limit the country’s ability to retaliate against Israel and military bases in the region that house U.S. troops. American military officials say that while their bombers and Tomahawks can significantly damage Iran’s missiles, it could manufacture more. And Iran has spread out some of its launch sites, making an attack harder.
But any damage from a U.S. strike would more likely serve two symbolic purposes. Several administration officials said it would allow Mr. Trump to claim a military victory against an old foe. But top officials also hope it would drive Iran to give up its nuclear
Continued on Page A10

Trump’s New Idea for a Coin: Himself, Once Again, but Gold

By DAN BARRY
The Trump administration has worked hard to ensure that this year’s celebration of the nation’s 250th anniversary celebrates President Trump as well. Perhaps nothing reflects its concerted efforts better than a plan for a one-dollar coin depicting the president in profile, despite a national tradition of avoiding symbolism that even faintly evokes a monarchy.
But one Trump coin, it seems, is not celebration enough. The administration has now proposed an additional coin that portrays the president with fists planted on a desk, his face evoking a determination bordering on fury. This coin would match the dominant color scheme of just about every nook, cranny and plaster cherub in the Trump Oval Office.
Gold.
But the numismatic glorification of Mr. Trump has repeatedly met resistance from one of the more obscure corners of the federal government: an entity known as the Citizens Coinage Advisory Committee.



Statutorily required to review the themes and designs of proposed coins, the committee has wielded its limited powers to slow, if not block, these Trump coins from being struck by the U.S. Mint in time for the anniversary celebrations this summer.
The committee’s latest move came at the start of its monthly meeting on Tuesday, a few days after a curious notice appeared in the Federal Register. It was a last-minute addition to the meeting’s agenda by the U.S. Mint that said, simply: “review and discussion of a Semiquincentennial Gold Coin.”
Continued on Page A18



NATIONAL A13-21
Returning to the Subway
Joseph Lynskey, who was pushed into the path of train in 2024, has filed suit against the city and the M.T.A. PAGE A13

Hillary Clinton Questioned
The former secretary of state denied meeting Jeffrey Epstein during a deposition before a House panel. PAGE A17

INTERNATIONAL A4-12
A Lifesaving Alarm System
A rare look at the Ukrainian specialists responsible for alerting residents of potential Russian strikes. PAGE A9

Germany Proves a Tough Sell
Seeking allies, China finds that concerns with Beijing top frustration with President Trump. News Analysis. PAGE A9

OBITUARIES A23-25
Acclaimed French Composer
Éliane Radigue, whose Tibetan Buddhist spiritual practice and experiments with synthesizers came together in vast, slow-moving works, was 94. PAGE A23



SPORTS B7-10
Building a Rising Empire
Angel Reese has established herself as a multihyphenate: basketball star, model, businesswoman and actor. PAGE B7

Power Loves a Winner
The good feelings around the U.S. men’s hockey gold medal were repurposed into partisan political capital. PAGE B10

BUSINESS B1-6
Tabloids Weigh a Nickname
“Zo”? “Zoh”? “Mam”? Just about every New York City mayor has ended up with a nickname in the press, whether he likes it or not. Now it’s Zohran Mamdani’s turn. PAGE B1

A Chatbot Duty to Warn?
Users are entitled to privacy from the government, but when they reveal sensitive information to A.I. platforms, including plans to commit violent acts, should the police be alerted? PAGE B1

OPINION A26-27
Michelle Goldberg PAGE A26



WEEKEND C1-8
Hygge at the Guggenheim
Cushions and herbal tea add a cozy vibe to a retrospective of the sculptor Carol Bove that highlights rumpled ribbons of steel that look soft as suede. PAGE C1

